Story

The Count of Monte Cristo



Story

Introduction

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Introduction

(A) The Writer Alexandre Dumas (1802 – 1870) الكاتب

Alexandre Dumas was a famous French writer. He was born in France in 1802. He became well known for writing exciting adventure stories that many readers still enjoy today.

His most famous books are The Three Musketeers and The Count of Monte Cristo. His stories are full of action, bravery, loyalty, and friendship.

Dumas also wrote many plays and articles. He died in 1870, but his works continue to live on and inspire readers all over the world.

(B) Character Summary – *The Count of Monte Cristo*

Name	Role in the Story الدور فى الرواية	Main Traits الصفات الرئيسية	Classification التصنيف
Edmond Dantès	The hero who is wrongly imprisoned, then returns for revenge and justice and named himself the Count of Monte Cristo.	Kind, smart, brave, sometimes harsh, seeks justice	A good character
Mercédès	Edmond's fiancée; She loves him, but later marries Fernand when she thinks Edmond is dead.	Loving, faithful, kind-hearted, sad	A good character
Fernand Mondego	Edmond's rival who betrays him to marry Mercédès. He becomes rich, but dishonorable.	Jealous, selfish, traitor خائن	An evil character
Danglars	The greedy banker who helps in the plot against Edmond.	Greedy, envious, dishonest	An evil character
Ville fort	The ambitious judge who sent Edmond to prison without a trial to hide his family's secret.	Corrupt فاسد, selfish, hypocrite منافق	An evil character
Caderousse	A neighbor and false friend to Edmond who knows the truth, but stayed silent.	Greedy طماع, weak, coward جبان	An evil character
Abbé Faria	A wise, old prisoner who teaches Edmond and tells him about the hidden treasure.	Wise, kind, intelligent	A good character
Monsieur Morrel	The ship owner who tries to help Edmond and his family.	Loyal, generous, kind	A good character

Maximilian Morrel	The loyal son of Edmond's old employer. He is in love with Valentine.	Brave, loyal, romantic	A good character
Valentine	Ville fort's daughter, who is in love with Maximilian Morrel.	Kind, gentle, honest	A good character
Haydée	A young woman rescued by Edmond. She becomes close to him at the end.	Noble, kind, brave	A good character
Albert	Son of Mercédès and Fernand; a noble young man.	Respectful, brave, fair	A good character

(c) Themes المواضيع

Revenge الانتقام

Edmond Dantès spends years planning his revenge. He punishes the people who betrayed him. Revenge gives him power, but also makes him bitter. In the end, he learns that forgiveness brings more peace than hatred.

Justice العدالة

The story asks if real justice comes from the law or from personal actions. Edmond becomes like an instrument of justice. He rewards the good people who helped him. He also teaches readers that justice must be fair, not cruel.

Hope الأمل

Hope keeps Edmond alive in prison. His friendship with Abbé Faria gives him courage. He never stops dreaming of freedom and a better life. Hope leads him to find treasure and rebuild his future.

Love and Loyalty الحب والإخلاص

Edmond's love for Mercédès is strong, but fate separates them. She stays loyal in her heart, even when she marries Fernand. Loyal friends like Abbé Faria and Maximilien show true devotion. The story teaches that real love and loyalty survive even in hard times.

Fate and Providence القدروالعناية الإلهية

The novel shows that human life is guided by fate. Edmond believes God gave him the treasure for a purpose. He sees himself as an agent of providence, rewarding the good and punishing the bad. In the end, he learns that only God controls destiny, not man.

Forgiveness الغفران

At first, Edmond cannot forgive anyone. His heart is full of anger and pain. Later, he understands that forgiveness is stronger than revenge. By forgiving, he finally finds peace for himself.

The message: The story teaches that revenge may seem powerful, but hope, justice, love, loyalty, and forgiveness bring true peace.

(D) Summary of the Plot

The Count of Monte Cristo is a famous adventure novel written by Alexandre Dumas. The story begins in France in the 19th century.

The story is about a young man named Edmond Dantès who is kind, honest, and successful. He is about to become the captain of a ship and marry the woman he loves, Mercédès. But some people are jealous of his success and they decide to make a plan to send him to prison. These men work together to accuse Edmond of being a spy جاسوس. Edmond is sent to prison without a trial. He spends 14 years in prison.

Edmond spends many years in a dark prison. In prison, Edmond meets Abbé Faria, an old, religious man who becomes his friend and teacher. Faria tells Edmond about a hidden treasure on the island of Monte Cristo.

After Faria dies, Edmond escapes from prison and finds the treasure. He becomes rich and powerful, and changes his name to *The Count of Monte Cristo* and begins a new life. He uses his new identity and fortune to find the people who hurt him and take his revenge.

He returns to France in secret to take revenge on the men who ruined his life. He punishes each of them, but he also helps the good people who were kind to him.

In the end, Edmond learns that forgiveness and peace are more important than revenge. He leaves to start a new life, hoping for happiness and freedom.

The story is full of mystery, adventure, and strong emotions like love, hope, and justice. It teaches us that even in the darkest times, we should not lose hope—and that revenge can be dangerous if it controls our lives.



Chapter (1) The Arrival at Marseilles

New Vocabulary — المفردات الرئيسية

accusation	اتهام	fiancée	خطيبة	prosecutor	المدعى العام		
ambitious	طموح	gangplank	لوح الصعود/النزول من السفينة	proudly	بفخر		
anchor	ترسو (السفينة)	gravely ill	مريض بشدة/مرض خطير	security	أمان		
authorities	السلطات	helm	دفة القيادة	shadows	الظلال		
betrothal feast	حفل خطوبة	humiliation	إهانة	treason/traitor	خيانة/خائن		
bitterness	مرارة/حقد	innocent	برىء	voyage	رحلة بحرية		
cargo	حمولة/بضائع	jealousy	غيرة	wages	أجور/رواتب		
command	قيادة	merchant	تاجر				
debt	دين	navigate	يوجّه/يقود	wisdom	حكمة		
exiled	منفى	poverty	فقر				

Phrases, Expressions, Idioms & Prepositions — التعبيرات والمصطلحات وحروف الجر

bring back	يعيد	light up	يضيء بالأمل	touched their faces	لامس وجوههم
burden	عبء	lips curled into a thin smile	ابتسم ابتسامة خفيفة	unaware of the hatred	غير مدرك للكراهية
carried good news	حمل أخبارًا سارة	lit with cruel hope	أضاء بأمل قاسٍ	walk through	يسير عبر
clenched his fists	قبض يديه	loyal	مخلص	want for nothing	لا ينقصه شيء
endless possibilities	احتمالات لا تنتهى	make up	يضع خطة/يؤلف	whispered softly	همس برقة
first mate of one of the finest ships	مساعد أول فى واحدة من أرقى السفن	muttered to himself	تمتم مع نفسه	with speed	بسرعة
heart beat faster	دق قلبه بسرعة	slipping into darkness	ينزلق نحو الظلام	words heavy with malice	كلمات ملينة بالشر
held him tightly	عانقه بشدة	spoke of him with respect	تحدثوا عنه باحترام		
hold on	يتمسك/يمسك بشدة	stood frozen with shock	تجمد من الصدمة	write down	يكتب
lean on	يتكئ على	tears in his eyes	دموع فى عينيه		

Summary in Points

1. Edmond Dantès returns to Marseille on the ship "Pharaon" after a long journey.

- يعود إدموند دانتيس إلى مارسيليا على السفينة «فرعون» بعد رحلة طويلة.

2. Edmond is only nineteen years old, but he is already the first mate of the ship.

- إدموند عمره تسعة عشر عامًا فقط، لكنه بالفعل مساعد القبطان الأول على السفينة.

3. During the journey, the captain becomes very ill, so Edmond takes command of the ship.

- أثناء الرحلة، يمرض القبطان بشدة، لذلك يتولى إدموند قيادة السفينة.

4. Edmond brings the ship home safely with all the cargo untouched.

- يعيد إدموند السفينة إلى الوطن بأمان وكل البضائع سليمة.

5. The sailors respect Edmond because he is brave, clever, and responsible.

- يحترم البحارة إدموند لأنه شجاع وذكى ويتحمل المسئولية.

6. At the port, Edmond sees the two people he loves most: his father and Mercédès.

- فى الميناء، يرى إدموند أكثر شخصين يحبهما: والده ومرسيدس.

7. His father is very happy and proud to see his son safe and successful.

- والده سعيد وفخور جدًا برؤية ابنه سالمًا وناجحًا.

8. Mercédès is also very happy because Edmond is safe and back with her.

- مرسيدس سعيدة جدًا أيضًا لأن إدموند عاد إليها سالمًا.

9. Edmond tells them that Monsieur Morrel may make him captain of the "Pharaon".

- يخبرهم إدموند أن السيد موريل قد يجعله قبطان السفينة « فرعون ».

10. Monsieur Morrel praises Edmond and promises him the captain's position.

- يمدح السيد موريل إدموند ويعده بمنصب القبطان.

11. Edmond and Mercédès dream of getting married soon and living happily together.

- يحلم إدموند ومرسيدس بالزواج قريبًا والعيش معًا بسعادة.

12. Fernand Mondego feels jealous because he loves Mercédès, but she has chosen Edmond.

- يشعر فرناند موندیجو بالغيرة لأنه يحب مرسيدس، لكنها اختارت إدموند.

13. Danglars also hates Edmond because Edmond has been promoted above him.

- يكره دانجلارز إدموند أيضًا لأن إدموند ترقّى فوقه.

14. Edmond does not know that Fernand and Danglars are full of hatred toward him.

- لا يعرف إدموند أن فرناند ودانجلارز ممتلئان بالكراهية تجاهه.

15. Edmond visits his father's small home and discovers that his father lived in poverty.

- يزور إدموند بيت والده الصغير ويكتشف أن والده عاش فى فقر.

16. His father had paid Edmond's debt, so he had almost no money left for food.

- لقد دفع والده دين إدموند، لذلك لم يتبق لديه أى أموال تقريبًا لشراء الطعام.

17. Edmond feels sad and gives his father all the money he earned.

- يشعر إدموند بالحزن ويعطى والده كل المال الذى كسبه.

18. Later, Edmond and Mercédès walk by the sea and speak about their future.

- بعد ذلك، يمشى إدموند ومرسيدس بجانب البحر ويتحدثان عن مستقبلهما.

19. They believe nothing can take their happiness away, but danger is already near.

- يعتقدان أن لا شىء يستطيع أخذ سعادتهما، لكن الخطر أصبح قريبًا بالفعل.

20. Danglars and Fernand meet secretly in a dark tavern to plan against Edmond.

- يلتقى دانجلارز وفرناند سرًا فى حانة مظلمة للتخطيط ضد إدموند.

21. Danglars suggests writing a false letter accusing Edmond of helping Napoleon's supporters.

- يقترح دانجلارز كتابة رسالة كاذبة تتهم إدموند بمساعدة أنصار نابليون.

22. Fernand agrees because he hopes Edmond will be arrested and Mercédès will become his wife.

- يوافق فرناند لأنه يأمل أن يتم القبض على إدموند وأن تصبح مرسيدس زوجته.

23. Fernand gives the false letter to the local prosecutor, and Edmond's future is put in danger.

- يسلم فرناند الرسالة الكاذبة إلى المدعى العام المحلى، ويصبح مستقبل إدموند فى خطر.

24. The next day, during Edmond's engagement feast, soldiers arrive and arrest him.

- فى اليوم التالى، أثناء مأدبة خطوبة إدموند، يصل الجنود ويعتقلونه.

25. Mercédès and Edmond's father are shocked, and Edmond's happy life turns into darkness.

- تصاب مرسيدس ووالد إدموند بالصدمة، وتتحول حياة إدموند السعيدة إلى ظلام.

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Chapter Text

A Young Sailor's Fortune

Edmond Dantès stood proudly at the front of the ship *Pharaon* as it entered the port of Marseille. The wind pushed the sails, the sea sparkled in the sunlight, and sailors hurried across the deck. For Edmond, this was not just another journey; it was the beginning of a new life. He was only nineteen years old, but already the first mate of one of the finest ships of his company. His heart was full of hope and dreams, for he carried good news for both his employer and his family.

The *Pharaon* had sailed from Smyrna, then stopped in Naples, and was finally returning to Marseille. On the voyage, the ship's captain had fallen gravely ill. Edmond, young and ambitious, had taken command. He navigated storms, negotiated with traders, and brought the ship safely home with its cargo untouched. His skill and bravery impressed everyone on board. Even the old sailors, who at first had doubted him, now spoke of him with respect.

As the ship neared the dock, a small crowd gathered to welcome it. Merchants, port workers, and families waited impatiently.

Edmond felt his heart beat faster, for among the crowd stood the two people he loved most: his father, an old man who had given everything for his son, and Mercédès, the beautiful young woman who was promised to him.

The ship anchored, and Edmond gave sharp, confident orders.

"Lower the sails! Prepare the ropes! Secure the cargo!" His voice carried across the deck, and the sailors obeyed with speed. When the gangplank was lowered, Edmond ran down, eager to embrace his father and Mercédès. His father held him tightly, tears in his eyes. Mercédès smiled, her dark hair shining in the sunlight, her eyes full of love.

"Edmond," she whispered, "you are safe. I prayed for you every day."

"I am safe, and more than that," Edmond replied. "I bring good news. The captain has died, but the owner, Monsieur Morrel, has promised to make me captain of the *Pharaon*. At nineteen, I shall have my own command!"

His father's hands trembled as he held him. "Captain! My son, you make me proud. Your mother would have been proud too."

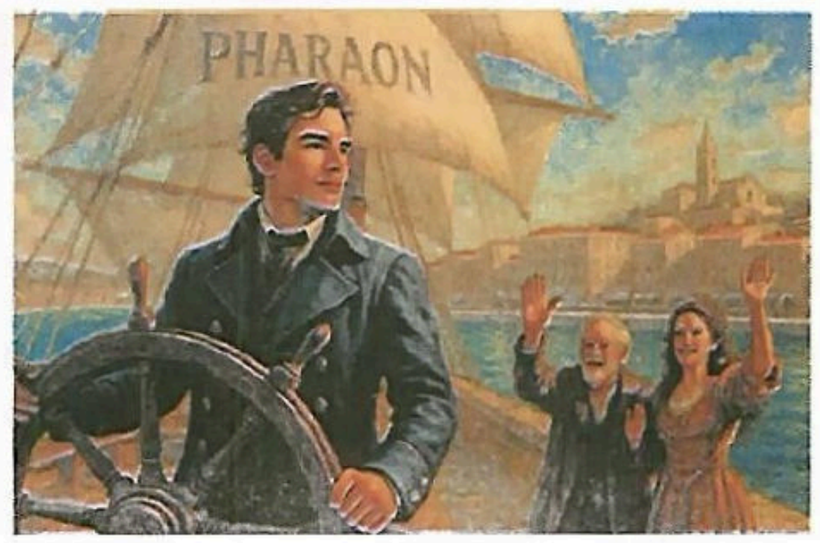
Mercédès lowered her eyes modestly, though joy filled her heart. To be the wife of a captain meant security and honor. She dreamed of a small home near the sea, children playing by the shore, and a future bright with happiness.

Monsieur Morrel soon appeared, a wealthy merchant with a kind smile. He greeted Edmond warmly and confirmed the promise. "You have shown courage and wisdom beyond your years. The *Pharaon* is yours to command, Edmond. Serve me faithfully, and you shall rise even higher."

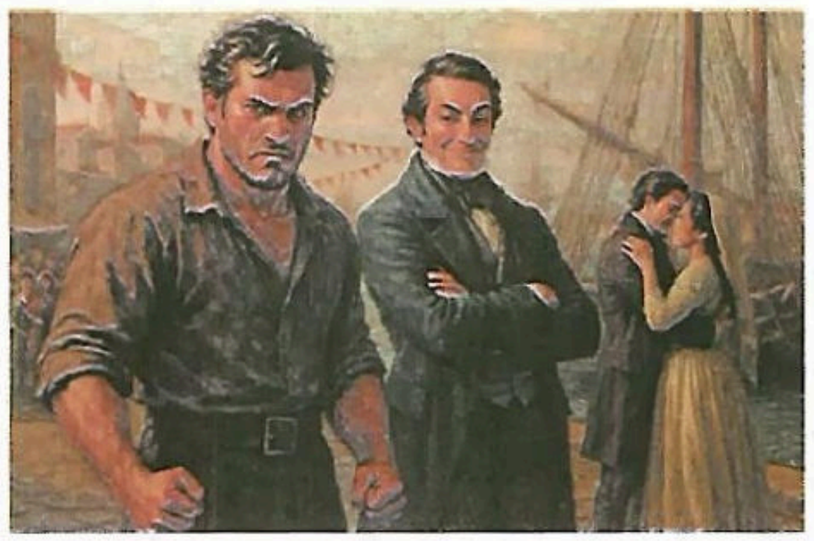
The crowd cheered, and Edmond felt as if the whole world celebrated with him. Yet, while most smiled, not every face was full of joy. Hidden among the crowd was Fernand Mondego, a fisherman from Catalonia. He stood silently, his fists clenched, his eyes burning with jealousy. For Fernand loved Mercédès too, and he had long dreamed of marrying her. But she had chosen Edmond, and Fernand's heart was filled with anger and envy.

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Another man, Danglars, the ship's purser, also looked at Edmond with bitterness. During the voyage, Edmond had been promoted above him, and Danglars could not forgive this humiliation. To see a nineteen-year-old boy given the command of the *Pharaon* was, for him, an insult. His lips curled into a thin smile as he muttered to himself, "Captain Dantès ... we shall see how long that lasts."



Unaware of the hatred growing around him, Edmond walked proudly through the streets of Marseille with his father and Mercédès at his side. They visited his father's small home, where Edmond discovered a painful truth: his father had lived in poverty while he was away. Out of duty, the old man had repaid a debt of money that Edmond owed to a neighbor, leaving himself almost nothing to eat. Edmond was heartbroken, but he quickly gave his father all the wages he had earned. "From now on, you will want for nothing," he promised.



The evening brought more joy. Edmond and Mercédès walked along the shore, speaking of their future. The sea breeze touched their faces, and the horizon seemed to promise endless possibilities.

They planned to marry as soon as possible. Mercédès leaned on Edmond's arm and whispered, "I wish this happiness could last forever."

"It will," Edmond answered confidently. "Nothing can take it from us."

But fate had other plans.

The Seeds of Betrayal

While Edmond celebrated, Danglars and Fernand met secretly in a dark tavern. They spoke in low voices, their words heavy with malice.

"Edmond has everything," Fernand hissed. "Mercédès, success, the captaincy. While I—who has loved her since childhood—am left with nothing."

"And I," said Danglars, "should be purser, second only to the captain. Instead, this boy takes the command, and I am forced to serve under him. His good fortune is insufferable."

The two men drank coffee, their eyes filled with hatred. It was then that Danglars suggested a plan. "What if Edmond were accused of being a traitor? What if someone wrote a letter to the authorities, claiming he carries messages from Napoleon's supporters?"

Fernand's eyes lit with cruel hope. "If he is arrested, he will lose Mercédès. She will be mine."

"Exactly," Danglars agreed. "And I shall have my revenge. He will never be captain if he is in prison."

That night, with careful handwriting, Danglars composed a letter. It accused Edmond Dantès of carrying a secret letter from Napoleon Bonaparte to his followers in Paris. The accusation was

false, but it was dangerous. The government feared Napoleon, who had been exiled but still had many loyal supporters. To be suspected of helping him was enough to destroy a man's life.

When the letter was finished, Fernand delivered it to the local prosecutor. With that single act, Edmond's future was poisoned.

Celebration and Shadows

The next day, Edmond's friends gathered for his betrothal feast. Laughter filled the air, music played, and tables were heavy with food and drinks. Mercédès wore a simple white dress, her face glowing with happiness.

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Cheers answered him, and for a moment, all seemed perfect.

But outside, in the shadows, soldiers approached. At the height of the celebration, the door opened, and an officer entered with cold authority.

"Edmond Dantès?" he asked.

"Yes," Edmond replied, surprised.

"You are under arrest by order of the king's prosecutor."

The room fell silent. Mercédès gasped, Edmond's father trembled, and Edmond himself stood frozen with shock. He had done nothing wrong, yet strong hands seized him and led him away.

The feast ended in confusion and sorrow. Mercédès cried out, "There must be a mistake! Edmond is innocent!" But her words were useless. The trap had closed, and Edmond's bright future was already slipping into darkness.

Chapter (1) Answered Exercises

1. What feelings might Edmond have had seeing his father and Mercédès in the crowd?

- ما المشاعر التى ربما شعر بها إدموند عندما رأى والده ومرسيدس وسط الحشد؟

- Edmond might have felt very happy and excited. He loved his father and Mercédès very much. Seeing them waiting for him made him feel proud, safe, and full of hope.

2. How did the sailors' opinion of Edmond change during the voyage?

- كيف تغير رأى البحارة فى إدموند أثناء الرحلة؟

- At first, some sailors doubted Edmond because he was young. But during the voyage, he showed courage and skill. He brought the ship home safely, so the sailors began to respect him.

3. Why did Mercédès feel joy when she saw Edmond safely return?

- لماذا شعرت مرسيدس بالفرح عندما رأت إدموند يعود بسلام؟

- Mercédès felt joy because she loved Edmond and was worried about him. She had prayed for his safety every day. When she saw him alive and safe, she felt very happy and relieved.

4. What does Edmond's promise to his father reveal about his character?

- ماذا يكشف وعد إدموند لوالده عن شخصيته؟

- Edmond's promise shows that he is kind, loving, and responsible. He cares about his father and does not want him to suffer. He wants to take care of him and give him a better life.

5. How does the promotion to captain affect Edmond's future?

- كيف تؤثر ترقية إدموند إلى قائد سفينة على مستقبله؟

- The promotion gives Edmond a bright future. It means he will have a good job, respect, and more money. It also makes his dream of marrying Mercédès easier and more secure.

6. Why is the evening walk with Mercédès important for their relationship?

- لماذا كانت نزهة المساء مع مرسيدس مهمة لعلاقتهما؟

- The evening walk is important because Edmond and Mercédès talk about their future together. They plan to get married soon. It shows their love, hope, and strong relationship.

7. What does Edmond mean when he says, "Nothing can take it from us"?

- ماذا يقصد إدموند عندما يقول: «لا شىء يستطيع أن يأخذ هذا منا»؟

- Edmond means that he believes their happiness will last forever. He feels confident that no problem can destroy their love or their future. He does not know that danger is already coming.

8. How do Danglars and Fernand's feelings contrast with Edmond's happiness?

- كيف تتناقض مشاعر دانجلارز وفرناند مع سعادة إدموند؟

- Edmond feels happy, hopeful, and proud. But Danglars and Fernand feel jealous, angry, and bitter. While Edmond celebrates his success, they secretly plan to destroy him.

9. What qualities of Edmond impressed everyone on the ship?

- ما هى صفات إدموند التى أثارت إعجاب الجميع على متن السفينة؟

- Edmond impressed everyone because he was brave, clever, responsible, and calm. He knew how to lead the sailors and protect the ship. He acted like a real captain.

10. How did the captain's death affect Edmond's life?

- كيف أثرت وفاة القبطان على حياة إدموند؟

- The captain's death changed Edmond's life because Edmond had to take command of the ship. He did a very good job, so Monsieur Morrel promised to make him captain. This gave Edmond a great chance for success.

11. Why do you think Danglars muttered, "we shall see how long that lasts"?

- لماذا تعتقد أن دانجلارز تمتم قائلاً: «سنرى إلى متى سيستمر ذلك»؟

- Danglars said this because he was jealous of Edmond. He did not want Edmond to become captain. His words show that he was already thinking about a way to hurt Edmond and stop his success.

12. The writer says, "fate had other plans." Do you think what happened to Edmond was bad luck, or was it because of the two men's plan? Explain your answer.

- يقول الكاتب: «كان للقدر خطط أخرى». هل تعتقد أن ما حدث لإدموند كان حظًا سيئًا، أم بسبب خطة الرجلين؟ وضح إجابتك.

- I think it was mostly because of the two men's plan. Edmond was innocent and did not do anything wrong. Danglars wrote the false letter, and Fernand delivered it. Bad luck helped them, but their jealousy caused Edmond's problem.

13. Edmond is very happy and proud at his party. How does this make the surprise ending, the arrest, more powerful or shocking for the reader?

- إدموند سعيد وفخورٌ جدًا فى حفلته. كيف يجعل ذلك النهاية المفاجئة، وهى القبض عليه، أقوى وأكثر صدمة للقارئ؟

- The arrest is more shocking because Edmond is at the happiest moment of his life. He is celebrating his love, his future, and his new job. Suddenly, everything changes. This makes the reader feel surprised and sad for him.

14. Who do you think is more guilty: Danglars, who wrote the letter, or Fernand, who delivered it? Why?

- من تعتقد أنه أكثر ذنبًا: دانجلارز الذى كتب الرسالة، أم فرناند الذى سلّمها؟ ولماذا؟

- I think both are guilty, but Danglars may be more guilty because he created the plan and wrote the false letter. However, Fernand is also guilty because he delivered it and wanted Edmond to lose Mercédès.

15. If you were Mercédès, what would you do after the soldiers take Edmond? Who would you talk to? What would you say?

- إذا كنت مكان مرسيدس، ماذا كنت ستفعل بعد أن أخذ الجنود إدموند؟ مع من كنت ستتحدث؟ وماذا كنت ستقول؟

- If I were Mercédès, I would try to find out where Edmond was taken. I would talk to Monsieur Morrel because he respected Edmond and could help him. I would say, "Edmond is innocent. Please help me prove the truth and bring him back."

16. The story shows that success can make some people jealous. Is this always true? What can a person do to avoid making others jealous when they are successful?

- تظهر القصة أن النجاح يمكن أن يثير غيرة بعض الناس. هل هذا صحيح دائما؟ ماذا يستطيع الإنسان أن يفعل ليتجنب إثارة غيرة الآخرين عندما ينجح؟

- No, this is not always true. Good people can feel happy for others when they succeed. But some people may feel jealous if they compare themselves to others. A successful person should be humble, kind, and respectful. He should not show off or make others feel small.

17. Imagine you are a friend of Edmond on the ship. You see that Danglars is angry. What could you say to Edmond to warn him?

- تخيل أنك صديق لإدموند على متن السفينة. ترى أن دانجلارز غاضب. ماذا يمكنك أن تقول لإدموند لتحذيره؟

- I would say, "Edmond, be careful. I think Danglars is angry because you became captain. He may be jealous of you. Do not trust him too much, and watch what happens around you."

18. Pretend you are the king's prosecutor. You get the letter, but you are a smart and fair person. What are two questions you would ask before arresting Edmond?

- تخيل أنك المدعى العام للملك. وصلتك الرسالة، لكنك شخص ذكى وعادل. ما السؤالان اللذان ستسألهما قبل القبض على إدموند؟

- First, I would ask, "Who wrote this letter, and can we trust this person?"
- Second, I would ask, "Is there any real proof that Edmond is carrying secret messages?"
  A fair prosecutor should not arrest someone only because of one letter.

19. Why was Edmond respected by the crew after the captain's death? SB

- لماذا كان إدموند يحظى باحترام الطاقم بعد وفاة القبطان؟

- Edmond was respected because he took command of the ship bravely after the captain died. He guided the ship safely back to Marseille and protected the cargo. This showed the crew that he was responsible and skilled.

20. What can we guess about Edmond's personality from how he takes responsibility on the ship? SB

- ماذا يمكنا أن نستنتج عن شخصية إدموند من طريقة تحمله للمسئولية على السفينة؟

- We can guess that Edmond is brave, responsible, and mature. He does not run away from difficult situations. Even though he is young, he can lead others and make good decisions.

21. How does the arrival at Marseilles set the stage for both hope and danger in Edmond's life? SB

- كيف يمهد الوصول إلى مرسيليا الطريق للأمل والخطر فى حياة إدموند؟

- The arrival brings hope because Edmond sees his father and Mercédès, and he may become captain soon. But it also brings danger because Danglars and Fernand are jealous of him. While Edmond is happy, they are planning to hurt him.

22. Do you think Edmond's loyalty to his captain was more important than reaching his family quickly? Why or why not? SB

- هل تعتقد أن ولاء إدموند لقبطانه كان أهم من الوصول إلى عائلته بسرعة؟ ولماذا؟

- Yes, I think his loyalty was more important. Edmond had a duty to finish the voyage and bring the ship home safely. By doing this, he showed honor and responsibility, and this made his family proud of him.

23. If you were in Edmond's place, would you have acted differently with the ship and the crew? Explain. SB

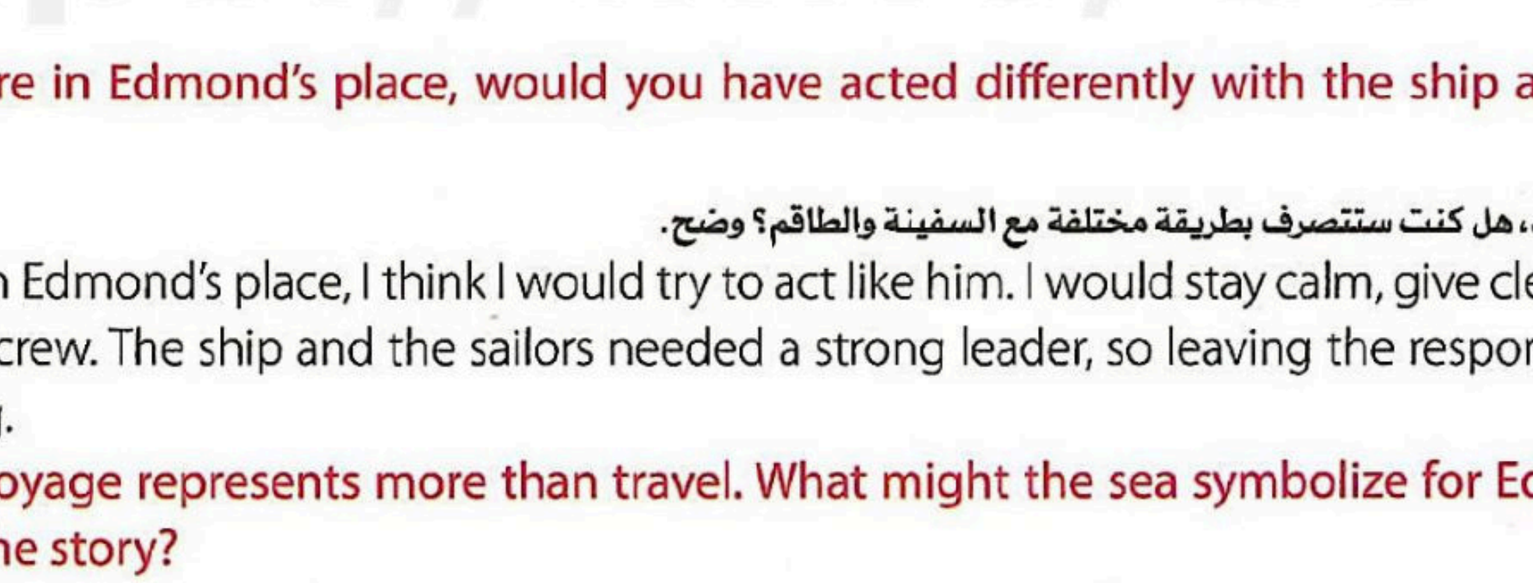
- لو كنت مكان إدموند، هل كنت ستتصرف بطريقة مختلفة مع السفينة والطاقم؟ وضح.

- If I were in Edmond's place, I think I would try to act like him. I would stay calm, give clear orders, and help the crew. The ship and the sailors needed a strong leader, so leaving the responsibility would be wrong.

24. The sea voyage represents more than travel. What might the sea symbolize for Edmond at this point in the story? SB

- تمثل الرحلة البحرية أكثر من مجرد سفر. ماذا يمكن أن يرمز البحر لإدموند فى هذه المرحلة من القصة؟

- The sea might symbolize hope, freedom, and a new future for Edmond. It brings him back to his family and Mercédès. It also gives him the chance to prove himself and become captain.



Practice... Chapter (1) Exercises

Answer the following questions:

1. Why do you think Danglars' ambition was especially dangerous for Edmond?

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.....

2. Why do you think Monsieur Morrel trusted Edmond with the captaincy?

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.....

3. Do you think Edmond was so confident about his future? Why or why not?

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.....

4. How do you think the reaction of the cheering crowd contrasted with Fernand's and Danglars' feelings?

.....

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5. What does Mercédès' dream of a small home near the sea reveal about her character?

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6. Do you think Edmond's loyalty to his captain was more important than reaching his family quickly? Why?

.....

.....

7. If you were in Edmond's place, would you have acted differently with the ship and the crew? Explain.

.....

.....

8. Why do you think Morrel offered Dantès the position of captain?

.....

.....

9. How does the character of Danglars, the ship's purser, contrast with Edmond Dantès?

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.....

10. Why do you think Danglars made an enemy of Dantès?

.....

.....

11. While the crowd cheered for Edmond's captaincy, Fernand and Danglars didn't show their jealousy. Explain with reasons.

.....

.....

12. The journey Edmond traveled on was the beginning of a new life. Explain

.....

.....

13. What do Edmond's father and Mercédès's welcoming tell us about the role of family in Edmond's Life?

14. In your point of view, what qualities a ship's captain should have?

15. Do you think age is one of the reasons why Danglars doesn't like Edmond? "

16. What does Edmond's father's sacrifice tell us about his love and sense of responsibility towards his son?

17. "From now on, you will want for nothing." What does this show about Edmond's feelings towards his father?

18. "It will." Edmond answered confidently. "Nothing can take it from us." But fate had other plans. Explain.

19. How did Danglars plan to stop Edmond from being captain?

20. "And I shall have my revenge. He will never be captain if he is in prison." Do you think that Danglars has the right to take revenge of Edmond? Why? Why not?

21. Why do you think the government feared Napoleon despite being exiled?

22. What do the characters of Danglars and Fernand represent in the story?

23. Edmond's betrothal feast turned into a disaster. Explain

24. How does the use of a false letter show the power of lies in shaping destiny?

25. Was Edmond's father right to repay his son's debt even though he was poor? Why or why not?

Chapter (2) A Treacherous Plot

New Vocabulary — المفردات الرئيسية

affection	المودة	eager	متحمّس/شديد الرغبة	royalist	مَلكى
ash	رَماد	envy	حَسَد/غيرة	scheme	مؤامرة/خطة خبيثة
beg	يتوسّل	executed	أعْدَمَ/نَفَّذَ	seal	خَتم
betrayal	الخيانة	fiancé(e)	خطيب(ة)	shackled	مُقيَّد بالسلاسل
bitter	مُرّ	flames	ألسنة اللهب	sincerity	إخلاص/صدق
ceremony	احتفال	fortress-prison	سِجن حصين	supporters	أنصار
collapse	ينهار	glances	نظرات سريعة	throne	العرش
consume	يلتهم/يحترق	grimly	بصرامة/بوجه عابس	traitor	خائن
destiny	القدر	humble	متواضع/بسيط		
deputy prosecutor	نائب المدعى العام	infamous	سيّئ السّمعة	treason	خيانة عظمى
determination	عزيمة	pleading	توسُّل		

Phrases, Expressions, Idioms & Prepositions — التعبيرات والمصطلحات وحروف الجر

a garment of mourning	لباس حداد	grew weaker with grief	ضعُف من شدة الحزن	slip away	يتلاشى
bring him before me	أحضروه أمامى	his hands were bound	كانت يداه مقيدتين	the clanging of the prison doors	قرقعة أبواب السجن
dragged from his cell	سُحِب من زنزانته	his heart pounded	خفق قلبه بقوة	the flames consumed the paper	اللهب التهم الورق
exchanged satisfied glances	تبادلوا نظرات رِضا	loyalty unshaken	ولاؤها ثابت	the sea has swallowed him	البحر ابتلعه
fell on deaf ears	وقع على آذان صماء	no chains could break that bond	لا قيود تكسر تلك الرابطة	threw the letter into the fire	ألقى الرسالة فى النار
from a distance	من بُعد	placed into the hands of	وُضعت فى يدى/سُلِّمت إلى	voice grew cold	صار صوته باردًا

Summary in Points

1. Edmond's joyful engagement celebration suddenly turns into shock when soldiers arrive and arrest him in front of everyone.

- يتحول احتفال خطوبة إدموند الممتلئ بالفرح فجأة إلى صدمة عندما يصل الجنود ويقبضون عليه أمام الجميع.

2. Mercédès and Edmond's father are devastated, but they still believe strongly that he is innocent and wrongly accused.

- تشعر مرسيدس ووالد إدموند بحزن شديد، لكنهما ما زالا يؤمنان بقوة بأنه برىء ومتهم ظلمًا.

3. Danglars and Fernand secretly feel satisfied because their plan to remove Edmond from their lives has succeeded.

- يشعر دانجلارز وفرناند بالرضا سرًا لأن خطتهما لإبعاد إدموند عن حياتهما قد نجحت.

4. A false letter is used as evidence, accusing Edmond of carrying an important message from Napoleon to his supporters.

- تُستخدم رسالة مزيفة كدليل، تتهم إدموند بحمل رسالة مهمة من نابليون إلى أنصاره.

5. Ville fort, the deputy prosecutor, is ambitious and more concerned about protecting his future than finding the truth.

- فيلفور، نائب المدعى العام، طموح ويهتم بحماية مستقبله أكثر من اهتمامه بإظهار الحقيقة.

6. Edmond explains honestly that he only agreed to deliver the letter as a promise to his dying captain.

- يوضح إدموند بصراحة أنه وافق فقط على تسليم الرسالة كوفاء بوعده لقائده المحتضر.

7. Edmond insists that he never read the letter and had no idea it was related to politics or danger.

- يؤكد إدموند أنه لم يقرأ الرسالة أبدًا ولم يكن يعلم أنها مرتبطة بالسياسة أو الخطر.

8. Ville fort becomes shocked when he discovers that the letter is actually addressed to his own father.

- يُصدم فيلفور عندما يكتشف أن الرسالة موجهة فى الحقيقة إلى والده.

9. Even though Edmond is clearly innocent, Ville fort chooses to protect himself instead of doing what is right.

- على الرغم من أن إدموند برىء بشكل واضح، إلا أن فيلفور اختار حماية نفسه بدلاً من فعل ما هو صحيح.

10. Ville fort orders Edmond to be sent to the dangerous prison of Château d'If to keep the secret hidden.

- يأمر فيلفور بإرسال إدموند إلى سجن قلعة إيف الخطير لإخفاء السر.

11. Mercédès desperately tries to defend Edmond and prove his innocence, but no one in authority listens to her.

- تحاول مرسيدس بيأس الدفاع عن إدموند وإثبات براءته، لكن لا أحد من المسئولين يستمع إليها.

12. Edmond's father becomes weaker and more broken with grief, as his only son is taken away from him.

- يصبح والد إدموند أضعف وأكثر حزنًا، لأن ابنه الوحيد قد أُخذ منه.

13. Danglars begins to imagine gaining power and control over the ship now that Edmond is no longer there.

- يبدأ دانجلارز فى تخيل حصوله على نفوذ وسيطرة على السفينة بعد غياب إدموند.

14. Fernand pretends to care for Mercédès, but secretly hopes her sadness will make her accept him instead.

- يتظاهر فرناند بالاهتمام بمرسيدس، لكنه يأمل سرًا أن يجعلها حزنها تقبله بدلًا من إدموند.

15. Mercédès remains loyal and promises that she will wait for Edmond no matter how long he is gone.

- تبقى مرسيدس مخلصة وتعد بأنها ستنتظر إدموند مهما طال غيابه.

16. Ville fort burns the letter in secret to destroy the evidence that could ruin his father and his career.

- يحرق فيلفور الرسالة سرًا ليدمر الدليل الذى قد يدمر والده ومستقبله.

17. Edmond is taken away by boat toward the prison, feeling confused, scared, and unable to understand his fate.

- يتم نقل إدموند بالقارب نحو السجن، وهو يشعر بالارتباك والخوف وعدم القدرة على فهم مصيره.

18. As he looks back at Marseille, he feels deep pain thinking about his father, his home, and Mercédès.

- عندما ينظر إلى مرسيليا، يشعر بألم عميق عندما يفكر فى والده ومنزله ومرسيدس.

19. When the prison doors close behind him, Edmond realizes that he has lost his freedom and everything he loves.

- عندما تُغلق أبواب السجن خلفه، يدرك إدموند أنه فقد حريته وكل ما يحبه.

20. Although his enemies believe he is gone forever, Edmond's memory and love still live strongly in Mercédès's heart.

- رغم أن أعداءه يعتقدون أنه انتهى للأبد، إلا أن ذكراه وحبه ما زالا يعيشان بقوة فى قلب مرسيدس.

Chapter Text

The celebration of Edmond Dantès's betrothal had ended in shock and silence. The music had stopped, the sweets had turned bitter in the mouths of the guests,
and Mercédès's white dress, once a symbol of joy, now seemed like a garment of mourning. Edmond had been taken away by soldiers, accused of crimes he did not even understand.

Mercédès clung to Edmond's father, her face pale and wet with tears. "They cannot keep him," she whispered. "Edmond is innocent. Everyone knows it."

The old man nodded, though his hands trembled. "Yes, child, but envy is a cruel enemy. I fear something dark has been planned."

Indeed, outside the walls of their humble home, two men congratulated themselves in secret: Danglars and Fernand. They had succeeded in their scheme, and now they waited for the storm to destroy their rival.

The Letter of Betrayal



The false letter, written by Danglars and delivered by Fernand, had been placed into the hands of Gérard de Ville fort, the deputy prosecutor of Marseille. Ville fort was a young man of ambition, eager to rise in government. He read the accusation carefully: *Edmond Dantès, sailor of the ship Pharaon, carries a letter from Napoleon Bonaparte to his supporters in Paris.*

At once, Ville fort's face darkened. Though many such letters had been rumored, this one carried danger. The country was ruled by King Louis XVIII, restored to the throne after Napoleon's defeat. Any hint of Bonapartist activity was treated as treason. To protect the king, men had been executed for far less.

"Bring this Edmond Dantès before me," Ville fort ordered. "We shall see what truth lies behind his smile."

Interrogation

Edmond was taken into a cold, stone room. His hands were bound, but his spirit was unbroken. He stood tall before the deputy prosecutor, confused but not afraid.

"Monsieur Dantès," Ville fort began, "you are accused of carrying a letter from the exiled Emperor Napoleon to his supporters in Paris. What say you?"

Edmond's eyes widened with astonishment. "A letter? Yes, I was given a letter on the island of Elba by the dying captain of my ship. He begged me to deliver it, and I promised. I did not even read it. It was an act of duty, nothing more."

Ville fort leaned forward, his eyes sharp. "Do you know to whom this letter was addressed?"

"No, monsieur," Edmond said honestly. "I only know it was to be delivered in Paris. I wished only to keep my word to my captain. I am a sailor, not a politician."

The sincerity in Edmond's voice would have touched any fair-hearted judge. But Ville fort's ambition clouded his sense of justice. For when he broke the seal and read the letter, he discovered a terrible truth: it was addressed to a Bonapartist leader—his own father. If the letter became public, Ville fort's family name would be ruined, and his career destroyed.

His heart pounded as he faced the young sailor. Here was a man innocent of plotting, yet carrying evidence that could bring shame upon him.

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"You admit to carrying this letter?" Ville fort demanded.

"Yes," Edmond replied. "But I swear to you, I had no idea of its contents. I would gladly burn it if it causes harm."

Ville fort studied Edmond for a long moment. He saw the honesty, the innocence, the youth. Part of him longed to release the boy and clear his name, but his ambition refused.

Ville fort's voice grew cold. "Edmond Dantès, you have confessed to carrying a letter from the enemy of the king. For this, you are guilty of treason. Guards, take him to the Château d'If."

"No!" Edmond cried. "I am innocent! Please, listen to me—" But his words were drowned by the clanging of the prison doors.

Reactions in Marseille

When the news spread that Edmond had been imprisoned, shock and disbelief filled Marseille. Mercédès refused to believe it. She went from door to door, pleading with officials, crying out that Edmond was no traitor. "He knows only ships, sails, and the sea." she said desperately.

But her cries fell on deaf ears. The government was afraid of Napoleon's return, and any man accused of serving him was guilty in their eyes.

Edmond's father grew weaker with grief. He had only his son in the world, and now even that comfort had been torn from him. He sat for hours by the window, staring at the sea, whispering Edmond's name.



Meanwhile, Danglars and Fernand celebrated quietly. Danglars smiled to himself, imagining the *Pharaon* under his influence now that Edmond was gone. Fernand, though, cared only for Mercédès. He visited her daily, pretending to comfort her, but secretly hoping her despair would push her into his arms. Yet each time, Mercédès turned away, her loyalty to Edmond unshaken.

"I will wait for him," she said firmly. "If he is in prison for a hundred years, still I will wait."

Her words cut Fernand's heart like a knife.

Ville fort's Secret

Late at night, Ville fort sat in his study, the letter spread before him. His hands shook as he read his father's name once again. If the king discovered that Gérard de Ville fort's father was a traitor, all his dreams of power would collapse.

His fiancée's family was royalist, his own career depended on loyalty to the crown. Everything he had worked for could vanish in an instant.

"I must destroy this letter," Ville fort muttered. With cold determination, he threw the letter into the fire. The flames consumed the paper, turning it into ash.

Then he whispered, "Farewell, Edmond Dantès. You are sacrificed for my future."

The Journey to the Château d'If

At dawn, soldiers dragged Edmond from his cell. Shackled and pale, he was pushed into a small boat that carried him across the waters of Marseille. He looked desperately at the city—the port where he had dreamed of being captain, the house where his father waited, the streets where he had walked with Mercédès. Every sight pierced his heart like a blade.

"Where are you taking me?" he cried.

"To the Château d'If," one guard replied grimly.

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Edmond's blood turned cold. The Château d'If was a fortress-prison built on a rocky island, infamous for housing traitors and prisoners. Few who entered its gates ever returned.

As the boat approached the dark stone walls rising from the sea, Edmond's spirit sank. He stretched out his hands toward the city, shouting, "Mercédès! Father! Help me!" But no voice answered, only the crash of the waves against the rocks.

As the iron doors shut, he felt the world of freedom and love slip away, leaving only hollow pain within him."

The Plot Completed

Back in Marseille, Fernand and Danglars exchanged satisfied glances.

"Dantès is gone," Danglars said quietly. "The sea has swallowed him, though he lives still."

Fernand nodded, his eyes fixed on Mercédès from a distance.

"Yes, gone. And now she will be mine."

But deep in his heart, he knew the truth: though Edmond was imprisoned, his spirit lived on in the heart of Mercédès, and no chains could break that bond.

Chapter (2) Answered Exercises

1. Why did Edmond's father say envy is a cruel enemy? Do you agree?

– لماذا قال والد إدموند إن الحقد عدو قايس؟ هل توافق؟

- Because envy destroys people's lives. Yes, I agree.

2. What do Danglars and Fernand's actions tell us about jealousy?

ماذا تخبرنا أفعال دانجلارز وفرناند عن الغيرة؟

- Jealousy makes people selfish and cruel.

3. Do you think the letter alone was enough to prove Edmond guilty? Why?

– هل تعتقد أن الرسالة وحدها كانت كافية لإثبات إدانة إدموند؟ ولماذا؟

- No, because he didn't know its contents and was just obeying orders.

4. How do you think Ville fort's ambition affected his sense of justice?

– كيف برأيك أثّر طموح فيلفور على إحساسه بالعدالة؟

- He chose his career over being fair to Edmond.

5. If Ville fort had chosen fairness instead of ambition, what could have happened to Edmond?

– لو اختار فيلفور العدل بدلا من الطموح، ماذا كان سيحدث لإدموند؟

- Edmond would have been set free.

6. Why do you think Edmond's case was treated so harshly under King Louis XVIII?

– لماذا تم التعامل مع قضية إدموند بقسوة تحت حكم الملك لويس الثامن عشر؟

- Because the king feared Napoleon's return.

7. Why do you think Mercédès's pleas were ignored by the officials?

– لماذا تعتقد أن توسلات مرسيدس تم تجاهلها من المسئولين؟

- Because they cared more about fear of Napoleon than the truth.

8. Do you think Danglars cared more about power or revenge? Explain.

– هل تعتقد أن دانجلارز اهتم أكثر بالسلطة أم بالانتقام؟ وضح.

- More about revenge, because he hated Edmond's promotion.

9. How does burning the letter make Ville fort guilty of betrayal too?

– كيف يؤدى حرق الرسالة إلى جعل فيلفور مذنبًا بالخيانة أيضًا؟

- Because he hid the truth for his own benefit.

10. In your opinion, why was the Château d'If seen as a place of no return?

– برأيك، لماذا كان يُنظر إلى قلعة إيف على أنها مكان لا عودة منه؟

- I think this is because it's an isolated place on a rocky island. The guards may also be tough or violent.

11. If you were Mercédès, would you wait for Edmond or try to move on? Why?

– لو كنت مكان مرسيدس، هل كنت ستنتظر إدموند أم تحاول المضى قدمًا؟ ولماذا؟

- I would wait, because true love is patient.

12. Imagine you are Mercédès. Would you trust Fernand as a friend after noticing his envy? Explain.

– تخيل أنك مرسيدس. هل كنت ستثق بفرناند كصديق بعد أن لاحظت غيرته؟ وضح.

- No, because his envy shows he is not a true friend.

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13. The celebration of Edmond Dantès's betrothal had ended in shock and silence. Explain.

- انتهى احتفال خطوبة إدموند دانتيس بصدمة وصمت. وضح ذلك.

- The party ended in shock because soldiers came and arrested Edmond. Everyone was happy, then suddenly the celebration turned into fear and sadness.

14. "Yes, child, but envy is a cruel enemy. I fear something dark has been planned." What does this show about Edmond's father's character?

- نعم يا صغيرتى، لكن الحسد عدو قاسى. أخشى أن يكون هناك شىء مظلم تم التخطيط له». ماذا يظهر هذا عن شخصية والد إدموند؟

- It shows that Edmond's father is wise and worried. He understands that jealousy can make people do evil things.

15. In the Château d'If, Edmond experienced the slow death of hope. Explain.

- فى قلعة إيف، عاش إدموند الموت البطىء للأمل. وضح ذلك.

- Edmond slowly lost hope because he stayed in prison for a long time although he was innocent. He felt lonely and forgotten.

16. Do you think Edmond is a victim? Why?

هل تعتقد أن إدموند ضحية؟ لماذا؟

- Yes, Edmond is a victim because he was innocent. Other men destroyed his life because of jealousy and selfishness.

17. Compare the goals of Danglars, Fernand, and Ville fort. What did each man want to achieve by destroying Edmond?

- قارن بين أهداف دانجلارز وفرناند وفيلفور. ماذا أراد كل منهم؟

- Danglars wanted the captaincy. Fernand wanted Mercédès. Ville fort wanted to protect himself and his family name.

18. If you were Ville fort, what would you have done with the letter to protect yourself and be fair to Edmond?

- إذا كنت مكان فيلفور، ماذا كنت ستفعل بالرسالة لتحمى نفسك ولتكون عادلًا تجاه إدموند؟

- I would investigate the letter first and look for real proof. I would not arrest Edmond without clear evidence.

19. Which character do you think was the most treacherous? Why?

من أكثر شخصية خائنة فى رأيك؟ ولماذا؟

- Danglars was the most treacherous because he planned the crime and wrote the false letter against Edmond.

20. Compare Edmond's hope with Fernand's jealousy. How do these two emotions create conflict?

- قارن بين أمل إدموند وغيرة فرناند. كيف تسببت هذه المشاعر فى صراع؟

- Edmond's hope brought happiness, but Fernand's jealousy brought anger and betrayal.

21. What were Edmond and Mercédès planning for their future? SB

- ما الذى كان يخطط له إدموند ومرسيدس فى المستقبل؟

- Edmond and Mercédès were planning to get married soon and live a happy and peaceful life together. Edmond also hoped to become a captain and take care of his father.

22. How can we tell that Fernand's feelings for Mercédès were more than friendship? SB

- كيف نعرف أن مشاعر فرناند تجاه مرسيدس كانت أكثر من مجرد صداقة؟

- We can see that Fernand loved Mercédès because he felt jealous of Edmond and wanted her for himself, not just as a friend.

23. Do you think Edmond should have noticed Fernand's jealousy earlier? Why or why not? SB

- هل تعتقد أن إدموند كان يجب أن يلاحظ غيرة فرناند فى وقت مبكر؟ ولماذا؟

- Maybe Edmond could have noticed it, but he trusted people and had a kind heart, so he did not expect betrayal from someone close to him.

24. Imagine you are Mercédès. Would you trust Fernand as a friend after noticing his envy? Explain. SB

- تخيل أنك مرسيدس، هل ستثق فى فرناند كصديق بعد ملاحظة غيرته؟ وضح.

- No, I would not trust him because jealousy can lead to bad actions, and a true friend should be happy for me, not jealous.

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Practice... Chapter (2) Exercises

Answer the following questions:

1. Do you think Edmond deserved his fate, or was he only a victim?

2. If the captain had lived, which characters' plans would have failed, and how?

3. How do you think Mercédès was different from Fernand in love?

4. If you were Mercédès, who would you ask for help?

5. How do you think the incidents might change if the captain lived?

6. If Mercédès had confronted Fernand directly, what would have happened?

7. Compare the courage of Edmond in the interrogation with the "courage" of Ville fort in his study.

8. How does the government's fear of Napoleon create an atmosphere where injustice is easier?

9. If Edmond had refused the captain's request, would that be moral or selfish? Explain.

10. How does Edmond's honesty during the interrogation make you feel about him?

11. What emotions do you think Edmond felt as he was taken to prison?

12. How would you describe Edmond's feelings as he stood accused of treason?

13. Was Ville fort more afraid for himself or for the king? Why?

14. Edmond said he carried the letter out of "duty." Do you think this was a good or a stupid reason? Why? Why not?

15. "Envy is a cruel enemy" In light of the story, how can envy be a destructive weapon?

16. What would have happened if the letter Edmond brought to Paris become public?

17. Mercédès was loyal to Edmond despite being accused of treason. Illustrate

18. "Farewell, Edmond Dantès. You are sacrificed for my future". Illustrate.

19. If you were Mercédès, would you stay loyal and wait for Edmond? Why?

20. Do you think the burned letter was Edmond's only evidence of innocence? Why? Why not?

21. If you were Ville fort, would you choose fairness instead of ambition? Why?

22. If Edmond and Mercédès marriage had happened without interference, do you think it would have been a successful marriage?

23. How does the incidents show the difference between true love and selfish desire?

24. Who do you think is the most guilty for Edmond's arrest: Danglars, Fernand, or Ville fort? Why?

Chapter (3) Betrayal and Arrest

New Vocabulary — المفردات الرئيسية

accusations	اتهامات	fortress	قلعة/حصن	pleading	متوسل/مستعطف		
charity	إحسان/صدقة	frail	ضعيف/واهن	rejoiced	ابتهجوا/فرحوا		
condemned	مدان/محكوم عليه	loyalty	ولاء	traitor	خائن		
denunciation	وشاية/اتهام	mildew	عفن/فطر				
despair	يأس	obsession	هوس	treacherous	خائن/غادر		
etched	منقوش/محفور فى الذاكرة	pity	يُشفق على				

Phrases, Expressions, Idioms & Prepositions — التعبيرات والمصطلحات وحروف الجر

carrying out the final wish	تنفيذ الرغبة الأخيرة	gave out	توقف/انقطع	slow death of hope	الموت البطىء للأمل
closing around him	تطوقه/تحيط به	in secret	فى الخفاء/سرًا	take root	يترسخ/يتجذر
collapsed on the straw	انهار على القش	late at night	فى وقت متأخر من الليل	torn between duty and ambition	ممزق بين الواجب والطموح
cry out to the heavens	يصرخ إلى السماء	no matter the cost	مهما كان الثمن	turned his eyes to	وجه نظره إلى
etched in the memory	محفور فى الذاكرة	refusing every suggestion	يرفض كل اقتراح	whispering his son's name	يهمس باسم ابنه
filled with fire	ممتلئ بالغضب/الحماسة	rot in prison	يتعفن فى السجن		

Summary in Points

1. Edmond's happy engagement night turns into a nightmare when soldiers arrest him suddenly.

- تتحول ليلة خطوبة إدموند السعيدة إلى كابوس عندما يقبض عليه الجنود فجأة.

2. His father and Mercédès are shocked and afraid as they see him taken away like a criminal.

- يُصاب والده ومرسيدس بالصدمة والخوف وهما يشاهدانه يُؤخذ وكأنه مجرم.

3. Danglars and Fernand secretly plan against Edmond and write a false letter to accuse him.

- يخطط دانجلارز وفرناند ضده سرًا ويكتبان رسالة مزيفة لاتهامه.

4. Edmond tries to defend himself and says he is loyal and only follows his captain's last wish.

- يحاول إدموند الدفاع عن نفسه ويقول إنه مخلص وينفذ فقط وصية قائده الأخيرة.

5. Ville fort realizes the letter can destroy his own future because it is connected to his father.

- يدرك فيلفور أن الرسالة قد تدمر مستقبله لأنها مرتبطة بوالده.

6. Although Edmond is innocent, Ville fort chooses to protect himself and accuses him of treason.

- رغم أن إدموند برىء، يختار فيلفور حماية نفسه ويتهمه بالخيانة.

7. News spreads in Marseille, and while some people feel sorry, others believe he is guilty.

- ينتشر الخبر فى مرسيليا؛ وبينما يتعاطف البعض معه، يعتقد آخرون أنه مذنب.

8. Mercédès and Morrel try hard to prove his innocence, but no one listens to them.

- تحاول مرسيدس وموريل جاهدين إثبات براءته، لكن لا يستمع إليهما أحد.

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9. Danglars dreams of gaining power, while Fernand tries to get close to Mercédès.

- يحلم دانجلارز بالحصول على نفوذ، بينما يحاول فرناند التقرب من مرسيدس.

10. Mercédès stays loyal and refuses to forget Edmond or accept Fernand.

- تظل مرسيدس مخلصة وترفض نسيان إدموند أو قبول فرناند.

11. In prison, Edmond begins to lose hope and feels deep sadness and loneliness.

- فى السجن، يبدأ إدموند يفقد الأمل ويشعر بحزن ووحدة شديدين.

12. The prison is dark, cold, and cruel, and the guards treat him badly.

- السجن مظلم وبارد وقاس، والحراس يعاملونه بسوء.

13. Edmond realizes he has lost everything: his freedom, his love, and his future.

- يدرك إدموند أنه يفقد كل شيء: حريته وحبه ومستقبله.

14. Time passes slowly, and Edmond spends his days alone with no one to help him.

- يمر الوقت ببطء، ويقضى إدموند أيامه وحيدًا دون أن يساعده أحد.

15. His father becomes weak and poor and eventually dies from sadness and loneliness.

- يصبح والده ضعيفًا وفقيرًا ويموت فى النهاية من الحزن والوحدة.

16. Morrel stays loyal and tries to support Edmond's father as much as he can.

- يظل موريل مخلصًا ويحاول مساعدة والد إدموند قدر استطاعته.

17. Mercédès suffers deeply and keeps waiting for Edmond every day near the sea.

- تعانى مرسيدس بشدة وتستمر فى انتظار إدموند كل يوم عند البحر.

18. Fernand hopes Edmond will never return, so he can have Mercédès for himself.

- يتمنى فرناند ألا يعود إدموند أبدًا حتى يفوز بمرسيدس لنفسه.

19. Ville fort is successful and powerful, but he sometimes feels guilty about Edmond.

- فيلفور شخص ناجح وقوى، لكنه أحيانًا يشعر بالذنب تجاه إدموند.

Chapter Text

The night of Edmond Dantès's arrest remained etched in the memory of all who had gathered to celebrate his betrothal. What should have been the happiest evening of his young life had become a nightmare. The music had stopped, the laughter had died, and soldiers had led him away as though he were a criminal. The faces of his father and Mercédès, full of terror and disbelief, haunted him as he sat alone in his cold prison cell.

Shadows of Conspiracy

Long before the soldiers had arrived, betrayal had already taken root. Danglars, the purser of the *Pharaon*, and Fernand, the jealous fisherman who desired Mercédès, had finished their treacherous letter of denunciation. Together they accused Edmond of being a traitor, secretly plotting against the country.

They had written with clever words, just enough truth to make the lie seem real. Edmond had indeed received a letter on the island of Elba, and he had promised his dying captain to deliver it. That innocent act of loyalty became twisted into proof of treason.

When the soldiers entered the feast, Edmond had no idea of the invisible web already closing around him.

The Interrogation

In the office of Gérard de Ville fort, deputy prosecutor of Marseille, Edmond tried to explain himself. His voice was steady at first, confident in his innocence.

"I am loyal to the king," he said. "I have never spoken with enemies". I am a sailor, monsieur, nothing more. I only carried out the final wish of my captain."

Ville fort, however, was torn between duty and ambition. In his hand lay the very letter that condemned not only Edmond but also Ville fort's own father. If the letter were revealed, his career would collapse, his future destroyed.

"You admit to carrying this letter?" Ville fort pressed.

"Yes," Edmond answered honestly, "but I did not know what it contained. I swear it, monsieur."

Ville fort burned the letter in secret, protecting himself, but condemned Edmond aloud. "By your own confession, you carried a message from the enemy of the king. That is treason."

Edmond's heart froze. "But I am innocent!" he cried.

"Perhaps," Ville fort replied coldly. "But the law does not ask for innocence. It asks for proof. And the proof condemns you."

The Arrest Confirmed

Back in Marseille, word spread quickly that Edmond had been taken to the Château d'If. People whispered his name in markets and taverns. Some pitied him, but others shrugged, saying, "Where there is smoke, there is fire."

Only those who truly loved him—his father, Mercédès, and Monsieur Morrel—refused to believe the accusations.

Mercédès, desperate, went to every official she could reach. "Edmond is no traitor," she pleaded. "His only love is the sea."

But her words met closed doors and deaf ears. No one dared question the orders of the prosecutor.

Morrel, Edmond's employer, went personally to the authorities, offering his word as a man of honor that Edmond was loyal. Yet even his respected voice carried no weight against the written denunciation.

Enemies in the Shadows

While the innocent fought for Edmond, his enemies quietly rejoiced.

Danglars, relieved to see the young sailor removed from command, already dreamed of power within the company. "With Dantès gone, I can shape the future of the *Pharaon* as I please," he thought.

Fernand, meanwhile, turned his eyes to Mercédès. He visited her often, pretending to be her comfort. "I know you suffer," he told her softly. "But Edmond is gone. They will not free him. You must not waste your youth in waiting."

But Mercédès shook her head, her eyes filled with fire. "I belong to Edmond. Until the day he returns, I will not listen to another."

Her loyalty stabbed Fernand with pain, but also fed his anger. "Then let him rot in the Château d'If," he muttered to himself. "One day you will have no choice but to turn to me."

Life Behind Bars

In the Château d'If, Edmond experienced the slow death of hope. The prison was a fortress of stone, standing on a lonely island, its windows barred and its corridors damp with sea air.

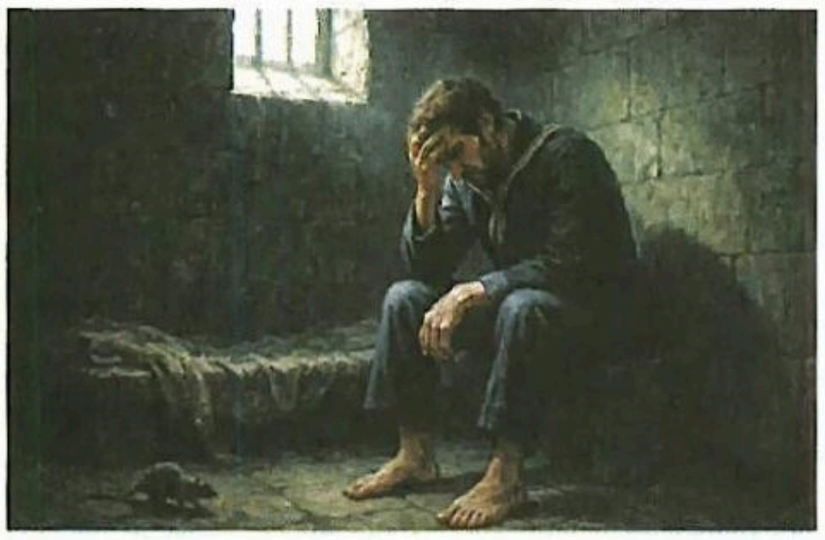
When Edmond first arrived, he begged for mercy. "There is a mistake," he cried to the jailer. "I am innocent!"

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The jailer laughed cruelly. "All here say the same, young man. Yet they remain."

Edmond was dragged through a long corridor lit only by torches. The smell of salt and mildew clung to the air. Guards mocked him as they pushed him into a narrow cell with a straw bed, a broken jug for water, and walls damp with cold. "This is your palace, captain," one guard sneered. Edmond's heart sank. The word "captain," once a promise of honor, now sounded like an insult. He collapsed on the straw, covering his face with his hands. In a single day he had lost his freedom, his father, his love, and his future. He cried out to the heavens, "Why am I here? What crime have I committed?" But the stones gave no answer.

Days passed into weeks, weeks into months. Edmond's youthful energy drained away, replaced by despair. He counted the stones in his cell, traced patterns in the cracks of the wall, and listened endlessly to the sea pounding against the rocks outside.



At times he shouted his innocence into the darkness, but no one listened. His only visitors were the guards who brought him bread and water.

The Suffering of His Father

Back in Marseille, Edmond's father grew weaker each day. Without his son's support, the old man fell into poverty and despair. He refused food, his only comfort the memory of Edmond's voice. Morrel, kind-hearted and loyal, tried to help him, but grief was stronger than charity.

"Your son is innocent," Morrel told him. "I swear to you, I will not abandon him."

The old man squeezed his hand weakly. "Tell him ... tell my Edmond ... that I loved him." Soon after, his frail heart gave out, and he died alone, whispering his son's name.

Mercédès's Despair

For Mercédès, each day without Edmond was torture. She waited at the shore, gazing at the island prison across the water, as if her eyes could pierce the walls and reach him.

She prayed constantly for his return, refusing every suggestion that she should forget him. Her beauty and loyalty only increased Fernand's obsession. He promised himself that if Edmond never returned, Mercédès would one day be his, no matter the cost.

Ville fort's Ambition

Meanwhile, Gérard de Ville fort enjoyed the rewards of his betrayal. By sending Edmond to prison and destroying the letter, he had secured his position with the royalists. He was praised for his vigilance, promoted for his loyalty, and prepared for marriage into a powerful family.

Yet sometimes, late at night, he dreamed of Edmond's face— honest, confused, and pleading.



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Chapter (3) Answered Exercises

1. How does the crowd's silence during his arrest reflect human behavior in the face of injustice?

- كيف يعكس صمت الجمهور أثناء اعتقاله السلوك الإنسانى فى مواجهة الظلم؟

- People feared authority and chose silence, showing how self-preservation often outweighs moral courage.

2. What does Ville fort's choice between his job duties and personal ambition tell us about human nature?

- ماذا يخبرنا اختيار فيلفور بين واجباته الوظيفية وطموحه الشخصى عن الطبيعة البشرية؟

- It shows how personal ambition can overshadow justice when one's future is at stake.

3. How might Edmond's honesty in admitting to carrying the letter have sealed his fate?

- كيف يمكن لصدق إدموند فى الاعتراف بحمل الرسالة أن يحسم مصيره؟

- His truthfulness provided the "proof" Ville fort needed, showing honesty can be exploited.

4. Could Ville fort have acted differently without destroying his career?

- هل كان بإمكان فيلفور أن يتصرف بشكل مختلف من دون تدمير مسيرته؟

- He might have sought a compromise, but fear of exposure left him blind to alternatives.

5. What does society's reaction "Where there is smoke, there is fire" suggest about human judgment?

- ماذا يوحى رد فعل المجتمع «حيث يوجد دخان، توجد نار» بشأن الحكم البشرى؟

- People often assume guilt without proof, preferring suspicion over careful reasoning.

6. How does the community's response highlight the loneliness of injustice?

- كيف تسلط استجابة المجتمع الضوء على الوحدة الناجمة عن الظلم؟

- Innocent people often stand abandoned when the majority chooses safety over truth.

7. What are the good and bad sides of Mercédès staying loyal?

- ما هى الجوانب الجيدة والسيئة لبقاء مرسيدس مخلصّة؟

- It gave her dignity, but trapped her in endless sorrow.

8. Why does Fernand's anger grow with Mercédès's rejection?

- لماذا يتزايد غضب فرناند بسبب رفض مرسيدس؟

- Rejection turned his love into bitterness, deepening his cruelty toward Edmond.

9. How does Edmond's treatment by guards reflect society's cruelty toward prisoners?

- كيف يعكس تعامل الحراس مع إدموند قسوة المجتمع تجاه السجناء؟

- Mockery سخرية and humiliation replaced compassion شفقة, dehumanizing مُهين للإنسانية him further.

10. Why was the word "captain" so painful for Edmond to hear in prison?

- لماذا كانت كلمة «كابتن» مؤلمة جدًا لإدموند عندما سمعها فى السجن؟

- It reminded him of lost honor, turning pride into humiliation.

11. What inner pain does Edmond reveal when he cries out to God?

- ما هو الألم الداخلى الذى يكشفه إدموند عندما يصرخ إلى الله؟

- It shows his search for meaning in suffering, even when unanswered.

12. What does the father's refusal of food symbolize?

- إلى ماذا يرمز رفض والد إدموند للطعام؟

- His despair and loss of will to live without his son.

13. How does Ville fort's success contrast with Edmond's suffering?

- كيف يتناقض نجاح فيلفور مع معاناة إدموند؟

- One gained power from the very betrayal that destroyed the other.

14. Why does Ville fort dream of Edmond's face despite his rewards?

- لماذا يحلم فيلفور بوجه إدموند رغم مكافآته؟

- His guilt haunted him, proving ambition cannot erase conscience.

15. "The word 'captain,' once a promise of honor, now sounded like an insult." How did Edmond feel about this word?

- كلمة «قبطان» التى كانت وعدًا بالشرف أصبحت تبدو كإهانة، كيف كان شعور إدموند تجاه هذه الكلمة؟

- Edmond felt sad and broken because the word reminded him of his lost dream, and it no longer had a good meaning for him.

16. Why was Edmond arrested even though he was innocent?

- لماذا تم القبض على إدموند رغم أنه برىء؟

- Edmond was arrested because of a false letter written by Danglars and Fernand, and because Ville fort wanted to protect himself, not the truth.

17. What does Fernand's and Danglars' betrayal tell us about their characters? SB

- بماذا تخبرنا خيانة فرناند ودانجلارز عن شخصياتهم؟

- Their betrayal shows that they are selfish and jealous, and they are ready to hurt others to get what they want.

18. How does this chapter show the theme of trust and deceit? SB

- كيف يوضح هذا الفصل فكرة الثقة والخداع؟

- This chapter shows that Edmond trusted people, but they deceived him, especially Danglars and Fernand who pretended to be good, but betrayed him.

19. Do you think the authorities acted fairly when they arrested Edmond? Why or why not? SB

- هل تعتقد أن السلطات تصرفت بعدل عندما قبضت على إدموند؟ ولماذا؟

- No, they did not act fairly because they did not try to find the truth and they punished him even though he was innocent.

20. The chains placed on Edmond symbolize more than imprisonment. What do they represent about his life and freedom? SB

- السلاسل التى وُضعت على إدموند ترمز لأكثر من السجن، ماذا تمثل فى حياته وحريته؟

- The chains represent that Edmond lost his freedom, his dreams, and his future, not just his physical freedom.



Practice... Chapter (3) Exercises

Answer the following questions:

1. Could Edmond have avoided his downfall if he had questioned the letter he carried?

2. How did the silence of the guests during his arrest reflect society's fear of authority?

3. What psychological effects did isolation in the Château d'If have on Edmond?

4. In what ways did Fernand manipulate يتلاعب بـ Mercédès's grief for his own gain?

5. How does Mercédès's loyalty to Edmond contrast with Fernand's selfishness?

6. Why does Ville fort's ambition stand in contrast to his hidden feelings of guilt?

7. How can mixing truth with lies make it harder to see what is real?

8. Edmond's innocent act of loyalty to the dead captain became twisted into proof of treason. Illustrate.

9. Ville fort was torn between duty and ambition. Explain

10. What central message about betrayal and justice does this chapter convey?

11. What should have been the happiest evening of Edmond's young life had become a nightmare. Explain

12. Long before the soldiers had arrived, betrayal had already taken root. Illustrate.

13. What does Fernand's and Danglars' betrayal tell us about their characters?

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14. How does Ville fort's decision show a conflict between personal interest and justice?

15. What might have happened if Mercédès and Morrel could convince Ville fort of Edmond's innocence?

16. Why did Edmond's cries of innocence fail to convince Ville fort?

17. Ville fort's act of hiding the truth led to Edmond's unfair punishment. Explain.

18. Why do you think some people believed Edmond was guilty even though he was innocent?

19. How do Mercédès's and Edmond's father's actions show courage in the face of injustice?

20. Why do you think Danglars and Fernand chose to betray Edmond instead of confronting him directly?

21. "But the law does not ask for innocence. It asks for proof. And the proof condemns you. "Are you for or against Ville fort's opinion? Why?

22. How does the different reaction of the people around Edmond reflect society's attitude toward guilt and innocence?

23. Mercedes set an example of loyalty and devotion. Illustrate

24. "I swear to you, I will not abandon him." What does this show about Morrel's character?

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